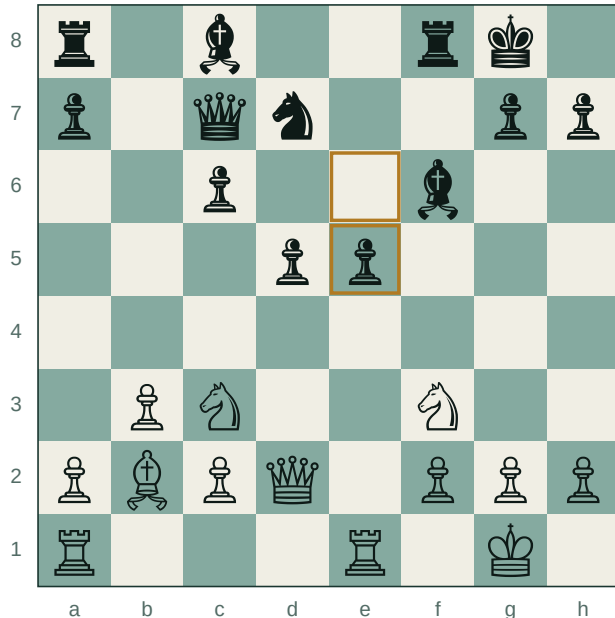


Interference tactics: White, move 15

Interference tactics

White to move



Previous move: 14...e5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

15. Nxd5 cxd5 16. Qxd5+ Kh8 17. Qxa8 Bb7 18. Qxa7

15.Nxd5 The knight captures the pawn on d5. From d5 it attacks queen on c7 and bishop on f6. Recorded reply: **15...cxd5**.

16.Qxd5+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From d5 it attacks king on g8, rook on a8 and knight on d7. Recorded reply: **16...Kh8**.

17.Qxa8 The queen captures the rook on a8. Recorded reply: **17...Bb7**.

18.Qxa7 The queen captures the pawn on a7.

At the end, nominal material is White 31 / Black 26 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from +0 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8 and queen on c7. Check for tactical protection.